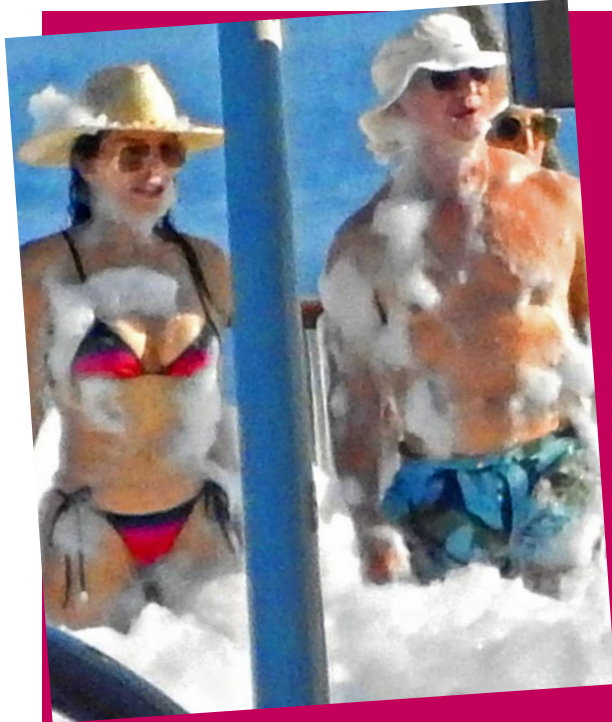




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HUMILIATING THREAT TO STARMER'S AUTHORITY

PM stunned by revolt on flagship benefits cuts as more than 120 Labour MPs vow to sink bill

KEIR Starmer was facing a humiliating threat to his authority last night as Labour's benefits rebellion continued to grow.

Labour MPs brushed aside

By **Jason Groves** Political Editor

pressure from Downing Street and threats from party whips to demand that plans to trim £5 billion from the welfare budget are dumped before a crunch vote next Tuesday.

Ministers were stunned by the

scale of the rebellion, with 108 MPs signing an amendment that would kill off the legislation needed to implement the cuts.

But, despite increasingly frantic lobbying from ministers, the scale of the rebellion continued to build, with sources claiming that another 19 MPs had signed

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**Alison Boshoff
EXCLUSIVE**

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